



“We tie up with... [top MNCs], industry leaders, experts, and academia to stay abreast of emerging trends, advance our capabilities in response to evolving technologies, and refresh our syllabus”

KRISHNA KUMAR
FOUNDER AND CEO, SIMPLILEARN

96 |

says Krishna Kumar, Founder and CEO of edtech firm Simplilearn. “To top it up with classes from top-tier university faculties, we have collaborated with the likes of MIT, IIMs, IITs, and Caltech,” he says, adding that Simplilearn also ties up with top MNCs, industry leaders, experts, and academia to stay abreast of emerging trends, advance its capabilities in response to evolving technologies, and refresh its syllabus every six to nine months.

JOB TRAINING

A work landscape where roles are being made redundant at a fast pace and replaced by newer ones has thrown up challenges not just for edtech firms but also for the marquee B-schools. That has also forced both to embrace each other to offer students a rounded experience by providing a thorough theoretical understanding of the business world along with training in the most sought after skills in the job market.

By bringing in the best of both worlds, such courses have become sought after by companies for in-house training. Bikram K. Nayak, Chief Human Resources Officer for Alumina Business at the mining and technology conglomerate Vedanta, says companies reward

those who put in their best efforts to meet the needs of the evolving workplace and hone their managerial skills. “This turns out in favour of the employees during evaluation. Thus, companies like Tata, L&T, and Vedanta, among others, have successfully embedded work-integrated learning programmes for their employees.”

But even for those who are not pursuing in-job training, edtech firms are trying to provide deep insights into the job market. UNext’s CEO, Ambrish Sinha, says that offering regular one-on-one mentorship, academic counselling, and peer networking opportunities are essential to building a sense of connection and purpose.

Kumar of upGrad feels that the future of eMBA programmes in India remains promising, despite the post-pandemic shift towards traditional education models. According to him, the biggest challenge edtech programmes face is the constant struggle for the working professional’s attention as they juggle work, life and classes. These firms have tried to address some of those challenges. For instance, upGrad offers human intervention to accelerate or augment the overall learning process. “For example, if a learner does not sign up onto the learning platform for a week or is facing challenges in keeping up with the project timelines, our mentors track their progress minutely to support them with the best possible solution and navigate through,” he adds.

According to him, traditional degrees still hold value, but employers are increasingly recognising the practicality and relevance of online management certificate programmes, especially for upskilling and niche areas. According to Kumar, this trend will continue to influence how companies recruit and promote employees. “Online certificate programmes in India will likely co-exist with traditional education, serving different needs—particularly for working professionals and learners who prioritise flexibility, affordability, and skills-based education,” he says.

But one thing students must remember is that these programmes are offered in collaboration with the universities. Rajat Agrawal, Professor at IIT Roorkee, which offers an online MBA programme in partnership with Coursera, says, “Edtech companies can’t independently run such degree courses.” So these courses are as good as or as relevant as the colleges that offer them. **BT**

@sudi_journalife